

Cloud OS

Jolicloud 1.0, a free HTML5-based web-centric Linux OS, releases to public

Age of Empires for Windows

Robot Entertainment announces Age of Empires MMO for Games for Windows

Ethical hacker publishes 100 million Facebook users' public information

A fifth of all 500 million Facebook user accounts were hacked by a security consultant, Ron Bowes, who wanted to prove how easy it still was to access user information. Using a 'piece of code' to scan and copy all data not hidden by 100 million users' privacy settings in Facebook's Directory, Bowes collected and uploaded it as a 2.79GB torrent for everyone to see. In other words, he managed to make public what was already public, and make it available in an indexed format. This does not seem very scary, but more on that later... For now, what does it contain?

User Profile URL, usernames (unique and by count), Processed lists (of first names

with count, last names with count, usernames with count, and more) and programs (used by Bowes generate the lists).

Not very philanthropic, Bowes isn't just showing how vulnerable Facebook is to such hacking, but is also taking things one step further by providing other, not so experienced hackers the perfect opportunity to use the data he has provided, which is ideal for many hacking techniques. Facebook isn't too concerned, claiming that the information that Bowes has 'stolen' is readily available anyway, and that no private data has been compromised, nothing that was kept in the 'Friends only'.

In other words, he succeeded in proving one of Facebook's security claims wrong –



Facebook user profiles cannot be indexed. Not only has Bowes made a whole bunch of indexed lists (by Unique ID and count), but he also went on to say: "So far, I have only indexed the searchable users, not their friends ... I'd like to tackle that in the future."

If you thought this data would be of little interest to anyone, think again. Although

it could just be employees, several major corporations were found downloading the torrents.

If you are starting to get spooked, this might be the perfect time to learn of Facebook's new faster account deletion feature which will allow you to terminate your account immediately instead of over weeks. **d**

Geolocation on Facebook, Places to Buzz

The web, especially the social web, is getting increasingly interested in your whereabouts. After "What are you doing?", it's now come to "What are you doing, and where are you doing it?"

Twitter added support for geolocation metadata in its tweets quite a while back, which could allow you to see tweets from people in areas around them. Google's Buzz also support metadata information in its messages, and can

show Buzz posts from users around you as a layer in Google Maps.

Facebook's take on geolocation, is called "Places". You can

use the feature with the iPhone via the Facebook iPhone app, or the <http://touch.facebook.com> web site if you have an HTML5 and geolocation capable phone,



and as we've come to expect, you need to be in the USA. There you shall see a "Places" option where you can tap the "Check In" button in order to see a list of nearby locations derived from your phone's GPS data. You can select the location you are at – or add it if it isn't already present – to have it posted on your wall.

Essentially, you can make a Facebook post which can include geodata and tag friends who are with you. Additionally you will be able to see an activity stream for each "Place". This makes "Places" or physical locations equivalent to Pages and Profiles, as points of activity. **d**